

It's math." But Money Beliefs are really, really hard to change—like some of the multimillionaires I know who are *still* anxious about money.

Let's try to dive into your own Money Beliefs. To start, what are the stories about money that you've been told?

- » That buying a house is a great investment?
- » That investing is like gambling?
- » That in order to become rich, the rich had to take advantage of someone?

I call some of these beliefs "invisible scripts": They are beliefs so deeply embedded, we don't even realize they affect our opinions, attitudes, and behaviors.

One of my favorite invisible scripts is that you "must" own a house. I rented an apartment in New York City for more than ten years. Renting was an excellent financial decision for me because it gave me far more flexibility and freedom than owning. In fact, after running the numbers, I *still* rent by choice. But if you grew up hearing things like "Real estate is the best investment," the thought of questioning home ownership seems unimaginable.

The first step is to recognize that these invisible scripts exist inside all of us. And once we identify them, we can decide how and to what extent we want them to influence our point of view and decisions.

I believe that one of the rarest things on Earth is having a strong point of view about your money. You don't *have* to buy a house—you can happily rent. You don't *have* to be an entrepreneur to be rich—you could work at a stable nine-to-five job that you absolutely love. And not every purchase you make *has* to provide a positive return on investment—you can just buy something because you want it!

My dream is for you to create a conscious idea of what you want your life to look like, then use your money to live it. In this section, you're going to examine the Money Beliefs that could be holding you back—and how to overcome them and move toward your Rich Life.